INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #19 · RELATIVES

“Family means I must put up with anything.”

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Where it often comes from

Family loyalty is a gift, but it can be bent into a trap. Some of us were taught that family comes first no matter what, that we should never speak about problems outside the home, or that forgiving means staying in harm’s way. This teaching can keep people in verbal, emotional, financial, or physical mistreatment.

What Scripture teaches

Proverbs says, “The prudent see danger and take cover, but the simple keep going and suffer the consequences.” Jesus taught, “If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately.” Paul says, “Speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ.” The psalmist calls us to “defend the cause of the weak and fatherless… Rescue the weak and needy.” God does not ask you to accept abuse in the name of family. Honoring family and protecting yourself can go together. If you are being harmed, safety comes first.

> *“The prudent see danger and take cover, but the simple keep going and suffer the consequences”* (Proverbs 22:3).

Also see

> “If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over” (Matthew 18:15).

> “Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head” (Ephesians 4:15).

> “Defend the cause of the weak and fatherless; uphold the rights of the afflicted and oppressed. Rescue the weak and needy; save them from the hand of the wicked” (Psalm 82:3–4).

> “If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone” (Romans 12:18).

Common self-statements

- Family always comes first, no matter what.
- I cannot say anything about how they treat me.
- Good family members take it.
- If I set limits, I am betraying them.
- What happens at home stays at home.
- They are my family, so I have to endure it.

Common logical errors

- Should statements: Insisting that I must tolerate anything from family.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must either accept everything or cut everyone off.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty about limits and concluding they are wrong.
- Minimizing: Treating harmful behavior as normal.

Challenging questions

- What behavior am I putting up with that hurts me or others?

- Where did I learn that loyalty means silence?
- What does Scripture say about protecting the vulnerable?
- What would a healthy limit look like?
- Who could I trust with the truth?
- Is anyone in danger now?

Truth summary

> Honoring my family does not mean accepting harm. I can speak the truth in love, set limits, and protect myself and others. If there is danger, I should seek safe help immediately.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Wisdom
- Child Abuse/Neglect
- Protection
- Communication
- Refuge/Safety

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Anger

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Same Power — Jeremy Camp
God's power challenges the belief that evil or fear has the final authority.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Family means I must put up with anything"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Family means I must put up with anything." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What am I putting up with?
- ☐ Where did I learn silence is loyal?
- ☐ What limit do I need?
- ☐ Who can I trust with the truth?
- ☐ Is anyone in danger?
- ☐ What is my safety plan?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The prudent take cover.
- ☐ I can speak the truth in love.
- ☐ Honoring family does not require accepting abuse.
- ☐ Protecting the vulnerable is God's heart.
- ☐ Limits can be loving.
- ☐ My safety matters.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 22:3
  "The prudent see danger and take cover, but the simple keep going and suffer the consequences."
- ☐ Matthew 18:15
  "If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over."
- ☐ Ephesians 4:15
  "Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A limit set: Each week, write one limit you set or one truth you spoke calmly.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 22:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The prudent take cover, and I can protect myself with God's wisdom.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Protection" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the behavior. Write specifically what happens and how it affects you.
- [ ] Talk to a safe person. Tell a pastor, counselor, or trusted friend what is happening.
- [ ] Plan a limit. Decide what you will and will not accept, and how to communicate it.
- [ ] Make a safety plan. If you or others are in danger, call 911 or the National Domestic Violence Hotline at 1-800-799-7233.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Family means I must put up with anything": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A limit set
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Family means I must put up with anything.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have been told to put up with things that hurt. Give me wisdom and courage to speak the truth, to protect myself and others, and to seek help where I need it. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.